

CHAPTER 5

See It

Building visual things with Claude

What you can build	How to ask for it	Where it works
Flowcharts and process maps	"Create a flowchart showing how [process] works"	Chat, Cowork
Charts and graphs	"Here's my data: [data]. Create a [bar/line/pie] chart showing [what you want to see]"	Chat, Cowork
Interactive calculators	"Build a calculator that [computes what]"	Chat (artifacts)
Decision tools	"Create a decision matrix for [decision] with these criteria: [criteria]"	Chat (artifacts)
Spreadsheets and trackers	"Build an Excel spreadsheet that tracks [what] with columns for [details]"	Cowork (saves to folder), Chat (download)
Dashboards	"Create a dashboard showing [metrics] from this data: [data]"	Chat (artifacts), Cowork

The Process (Same as Always)

Describe what you want and why → Look at what comes back → Tell Claude what's wrong → Iterate until it's right → Save it somewhere you'll use it

Tips for Better Visual Output

- Give Claude your actual data or a realistic example
- Tell Claude who the audience is — "my team," "my boss," "my students"
- Specify the format — "make it an Excel file," "show it as a flowchart," "build it as an interactive tool"
- Ask for color coding, formatting, or conditional logic if you want it
- Don't stop after the first version

Artifacts vs. Files

Artifacts (interactive, in the chat): Great for exploration, quick visuals, interactive tools, things you want to see and adjust quickly. **Files** (Excel, documents): Great for things you need to save, share, email, or put in a shared folder for your team.

*This reference card is a companion to Chapter 5 of Creating with Claude by Chris Thatcher.
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